

99. Consider the following statement(s) regarding Sankhya school

1. Sankhya does not accept the theory of rebirth or transmigration of soul.
2. Sankhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

100. Who among the following is known to have maintained the Silk Route and trade?

- (a) Ashoka (b) Kanishka
(c) Vima Kadphises (d) Vasudeva

101. The ruler of Kushan dynasty, Kanishka was the follower of

- (a) Jainism (b) Hinayanism
(c) Hinduism (d) Mahayanism

102. The famous book 'Brihat Katha' was written by

- (a) Gunadhya (b) Panini
(c) Sarva Varman (d) Radhagupt

103. Which of the following inscription are related to Satavahana period?

- (a) Nanaghat (b) Nasik
(c) Paithan (d) Both 'a' and 'b'

104. Consider the following place(s)

1. Ajanta Caves
2. Lepakshi Temple
3. Sanchi Stupa

Which of the above places is/are also known for mural paintings?

- (a) Only 1 (b) 1 and 2
(c) All of these (d) None of these

105. Who among the following were teachers of Gautama Buddha before his enlightenment?

1. Alara Kalama
2. Rudraka Ramputra
3. Makkhali Gosala
4. Nigantha Nataputta

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 4 (b) 4 and 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2

106. Which of the following ruler of Satavahana Empire composed Gathasaptashati?

- (a) Simuka
(b) Pulumayi
(c) Gautamiputra Satkarni
(d) Hala

107. "Heliodorus" a greek ambassador of the Indo-Greek king was sent to the court of which ruler?

- (a) Bhagbhadra (b) Devabhuti
(c) Pushyamitra (d) Ghosha

108. Which among the following rulers is often described as "the first empire builder of Indian History"?

- (a) Dhanananda
(b) Bimbisara
(c) Mahapadmananda
(d) Chandragupta Maurya

109. Who was the author of the book 'Silappadikarma'?

- (a) Ilango Adigal
(b) Perudevanar
(c) Seethalai Saathanaar
(d) Tiruttakrdeva

110. Which among the following is/are the terms used for coins of the Gupta period?

1. Dinara
2. Damma
3. Rupaka
4. Suvarna

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 4 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 4 (d) All of these

111. **Statement I** Virasen was the Commander-in-chief of Samudragupta during Northern campaign.

Statement II Samudragupta's arms reached as far as Kanchi, Tamil Nadu, where the Pallavas were compelled to recognise his suzerainty.

Codes

- (a) Both the statements are individually true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I
(b) Both the statements are individually true, but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I
(c) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false
(d) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true

112. Which of the following marriage is especially practised by warriors?

- (a) Daiva (b) Pisaka
(c) Rakshasa (d) Gandharva

113. In which of the following inscriptions Ashoka made his famous declaration, "All men are my children"?

- (a) Minor Rock Edict (Ahravra)
(b) Pillar Edict VII
(c) Separated Kalinga Rock Edict I
(d) Lumbini Pillar Edict

114. Rajashekhara was the teacher of which of the following ruler?

- (a) Bhoj
(b) Vijayalaya
(c) Mahendrapala
(d) Gopal

115. **Statement I** Harsha is called the last Great Hindu Emperor of India, but he was neither a staunch Hindu nor the ruler of the whole country.

Statement II Harsha defeated Pulakesin-II, the maitraka ruler of Vallabhi.

Codes

- (a) Both the statements are individually true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I
(b) Both the statements are individually true, but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I
(c) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false
(d) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true

QUESTIONS FROM CDS EXAM (2012-2016)

2012 (I)

- The site of Harappa is located on the bank of river
(a) Saraswati (b) Indus
(c) Beas (d) Ravi
- Ashokan inscriptions of Mansehra and Shahbazgadhi are written in
(a) Prakrit language, Kharoshthi script
(b) Prakrit language, Brahmi script
(c) Prakrit-Aramaic language, Brahmi script
(d) Aramaic language, Kharoshthi script
- Who among the following Chinese travellers visited the Kingdoms of Harshavardhana and Kumar Bhaskar Varma?
(a) I-Tsing (b) Fa-Hien
(c) Hiuen Tsang (d) Sun Shuyun
- Which one among the following Indus cities was known for water management?
(a) Lothal (b) Mohenjodaro
(c) Harappa (d) Dholavira
- Who among the following scholars were contemporary of Kanishka?
1. Ashvaghosa 2. Nagarjuna
3. Vasumitra 4. Chanakya
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 2 and 4 (d) 1, 2 and 3

2012 (II)

- The polity of the Harappan people, as derived from the material evidence, was
(a) secular-federalist
(b) theocratic-federalist
(c) oligarchic
(d) theocratic-unitary
- Silk routes are a good example of vibrant pre-modern trade and cultural links between distant parts of the world. Which one among the following is not true of silk routes?
(a) Historians have identified several silk route over land and sea
(b) Silk routes have linked Asia with Europe and Northern Africa

- Silk routes existed before the Christian era and thrived almost upto 15th century
- As a result of silk route trade, precious metals like gold and silver, flowed from Asia to Europe

- Which among the following statements regarding the Gupta Dynasty is/are correct?
1. The *Kumaramatyas* were the most important of the and they were appointed directly by the king in the home provinces.
2. The village headmen lost importance and of the transactions began to be effected without their consent.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- Which among the following materials were used for minting coins during the rule of the Mauryas?
(a) Gold and Silver
(b) Silver and Copper
(c) Copper and Bronze
(d) Gold and Copper
- What was the Kutagarashala literally, a hut with a pointed roof?
(a) A place where animals were kept
(b) A place where intellectual debates among Buddhist mendicants took place
(c) A place where weapons were stored
(d) A place to sleep
- The Dhamma propagated by Ashoka was
(a) the tenets of Buddhism
(b) a mixture of the philosophies of Ajivikas and Charvakas
(c) a system of morals consistent with the tenets of most of the sects of the time
(d) the religious policy of the state
- Which one among the following pairs is not properly matched?
(a) Megasthenese : Indica
(b) Ashvaghosa : Buddhacharita
(c) Panini : Mahabhashya
(d) Vishakhadatta : Mudrarakshasa

2013 (I)

- In the Gupta age, Varahamihira wrote the famous book, 'Brihat Samhita'. It was a treatise on
(a) astronomy
(b) statecraft
(c) ayurvedic system of medicine
(d) economics
- Which of the following was/were not related to Buddha's life?
1. Kanthaka
2. Alara Kalama
3. Channa
4. Goshala Maskariputra
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
(a) Only 1 (b) Only 4
(c) 1 and 2 (d) 3 and 4

Directions (Q. Nos. 15-16) The following questions consist of two statements, Statement I and Statement II. You are to examine these two statements carefully and select the answer to these questions using the codes given below.

Codes

- Both the statements are true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I
- Both the statements are true, but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I
- Statement I is true, but Statement II is false
- Statement I is false, but Statement II is true

- Statement I** There was great exodus of Jaina monks under the leadership of Bhadrabahu to the Deccan following severe famine in the Ganga valley towards the end of Chandragupta's reign.
Statement II Chandragupta Maurya joined the Jaina order as a monk.
- Statement I** Mahavira initially joined a group of ascetics called *Nirgranthas*.
Statement II The sect was founded 200 years earlier by Parsva.

2013 (II)

17. Statement I Kali age reflects the presence of deep social crisis characterised by *varnasankara* i.e. intermixture of varnas or social orders.

Statement II The Vaisyas and Sudras (peasants, artisans and labourers) either refused to perform producing functions or pay taxes or supply necessary labour for economic production resulting in weakening of Brahminical social order and social tension.

Codes

- (a) Both the statements are true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I
 (b) Both the statements are true, but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I
 (c) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false
 (d) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true

18. Among the precious stones, the most extensive foreign trade during the Gupta age was that of
 (a) diamonds (b) ruby
 (c) pearl (d) sapphire

19. Which of the following statement(s) is/are not correct about Bhakti tradition in South India?

1. Earliest Bhakti Movements in India were led by Alvar and Nayanar saints.
2. Naalayira Divya Prabandham, frequently described as Tamil Veda is an anthology of compositions by the Alvars.
3. Karaikkal Ammaiyar, women Alvar saints, supported patriarchal norms.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) Only 3
 (c) Only 2 (d) All of these

20. Sangam literature formed a very important source for the reconstruction of the history of South India. It was written in
 (a) Tamil (b) Kannada
 (c) Telugu (d) Malayalam

2014 (I)

21. The only inscribed stone portrait of Emperor Ashoka has been found at
 (a) Sanchi (b) Amaravati
 (c) Kanaganahalli (d) Ajanta

22. Which one of the following statements about Rig Veda is not correct?

- (a) Deities were worshipped through prayer and sacrificial rituals
 (b) The Gods are presented as powerful, who could be made to intervene in the world of men via the performance of sacrifices
 (c) The Gods were supposed to partake of the offerings as they were consumed by the fire
 (d) The sacrifices were performed in the temples

23. Consider the following statement(s)

1. The Jains believed that Mahavira had twenty-three predecessors.
2. Parshvanatha was twenty-third *Tirthankara*.
3. Rishabh was immediate successor of Mahavira.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
 (c) Only 2 (d) Only 3

24. Which one of the following statements about ancient Indian Mahajanapadas is correct?

- (a) All Mahajanapadas were oligarchies where power was exercised by a group of people
 (b) All Mahajanapadas were located in Eastern India
 (c) No army was maintained by the Mahajanapadas
 (d) Buddhist and Jaina texts list sixteen Mahajanapadas

25. The Fourth Buddhist Council was held in Kashmir under the leadership of

- (a) Bindusara (b) Ashoka
 (c) Kunal (d) Kanishka

2015 (I)

26. Which of the following characteristic(s) describes the nature of religion according to the Rig Veda?

1. Rig Vedic religion can be described as naturalistic polytheism.
2. There are striking similarities between the Rig Vedic religion and the ideas in the Iranian Avesta.
3. Vedic sacrifices were conducted in the house of the priest who was called *yajaman*.

4. Vedic sacrifices were of two kinds — those conducted by the householder and those that required ritual specialists.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 3 (b) 1 and 2
 (c) 1, 2 and 4 (d) All of these

2015 (II)

27. Patanjali was

- (a) a philosopher of the 'Yogachara' school
 (b) the author of a book on Ayurveda
 (c) a philosopher of the 'Madhyamika' school
 (d) the author of a commentary on Panini's Sanskrit grammar

28. Match the following

List I (King)	List II (Region)
A. Shashanka	1. Assam
B. Kharavela	2. Maharashtra
C. Simuka	3. Odisha
D. Bhaskara Varman	4. Bengal

Codes

- A B C D A B C D
 (a) 4 2 3 1 (b) 1 3 2 4
 (c) 4 3 2 1 (d) 1 2 3 4

29. In ancient India, the 'Yaudheyas' were

- (a) a sect of the Buddhism
 (b) a sect of the Jainism
 (c) a republican tribe
 (d) vassals of the Cholas

2016 (I)

30. Who among the following archaeologists was the first to identify similarities between a pre-Harappan culture and the mature Harappan culture?

- (a) Amalananda Ghosh
 (b) Rakhal Das Bannerjee
 (c) Daya Ram Sahni
 (d) Sir John Marshall

31. Consider the following statement(s)

1. Abhinavagupta wrote a comprehensive treatise called the *Tantraloka* which systematically presents the teachings of the *Kula* and *Trika* systems.
2. The *Samaraichchakaha* by Haribhadra Suri written in Gujarat around the 8th century is technically not a tantric work but is saturated with tantric ideas and practices.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

32. Which one among the following was not an attribute of Samudragupta described in *Prayag Prashasti*?

- (a) Sharp and polished intellect
(b) Accomplished sculptor
(c) Fine musical performances
(d) Poetical talent of a genius

33. Kamandaka's *Nitisara* is a contribution to

- (a) Logic and Philosophy
(b) Mathematics
(c) Political morality
(d) Grammar

34. The *Lilavati* of Bhaskara is a standard text on

- (a) Mathematics (b) Surgery
(c) Peotics (d) Linguistics

35. The *Agrahara* in early India was

- (a) the name of a village or land granted to Brahmins
(b) the garland of flowers of Agar
(c) the grant of land to officers and soldiers
(d) land of village settled by Vaishya farmers

36. Consider the following statement(s) about votive inscriptions in the 2nd century BC

1. They record gifts made to religious institutions.
2. They tell us about the idea of transference of the meritorious results of the action of one person to another person.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

37. Which of the following statement(s) is/are true?

1. Faxian's *Gaoseng Faxian Zhuan* was the earliest first-hand Chinese account of Buddhist sites and practices in India.
2. Faxian was only 25 year old at the time of writing the text.
3. Faxian's main aim in coming to India was to obtain and take back texts containing monastic rules.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 3 (b) Only 2
(c) 1 and 3 (d) All of these

> ANSWERS

Practice Exercise

1	b	2	d	3	b	4	d	5	b	6	c	7	a	8	a	9	c	10	b
11	b	12	b	13	d	14	c	15	c	16	d	17	b	18	d	19	a	20	b
21	a	22	a	23	d	24	c	25	d	26	d	27	c	28	d	29	d	30	d
31	b	32	c	33	d	34	c	35	b	36	c	37	a	38	c	39	b	40	a
41	a	42	d	43	d	44	b	45	b	46	d	47	c	48	d	49	a	50	b
51	d	52	a	53	c	54	c	55	a	56	a	57	a	58	a	59	b	60	c
61	b	62	b	63	a	64	c	65	c	66	b	67	d	68	d	69	c	70	a
71	c	72	b	73	a	74	a	75	c	76	b	77	d	78	c	79	a	80	d
81	d	82	c	83	c	84	c	85	b	86	d	87	c	88	d	89	a	90	d
91	c	92	b	93	c	94	c	95	a	96	c	97	c	98	a	99	c	100	b
101	d	102	a	103	d	104	b	105	d	106	d	107	a	108	c	109	a	110	d
111	b	112	c	113	c	114	c	115	c										

Questions from CDS Exam (2012-16)

1	d	2	d	3	c	4	d	5	d	6	c	7	a	8	a	9	b	10	b
11	c	12	c	13	a	14	b	15	b	16	b	17	a	18	d	19	b	20	a
21	c	22	d	23	a	24	d	25	d	26	c	27	d	28	c	29	c	30	a
31	c	32	b	33	c	34	a	35	a	36	a	37	c						

PART II MEDIEVAL INDIA

MUSLIM INVASION

Arab Conquest of Sind

- As Harshvardhana and Pulakesin II were struggling for supremacy in India, a revolutionary change was taking place, i.e. *the emergence of Islam in Arabia*.
- The Arabs, for long the carriers of Indian trade with Europe, were attracted by rich sea-ports of Sind. However, two expeditions sent by Al-Hajjaj the Governor of Iraq failed.
- The third expedition under his nephew and son-in-law Mohammed-bin-Qasim, managed to acquire control over Sind in AD 712. Multan was conquered in AD 713.

Mahmud of Ghazni

- Mahmud came to the throne of Ghazni in AD 997. He moved towards India in AD 1001 by attacking and killing Jaipala, the King of Punjab in the *First Battle of Waihind*. The first attack was made against frontier post and many forts and districts were captured.
- The sixth expedition (the Second Battle of Waihind) was against **Anandapala** (Hindu shahi ruler of Punjab) in AD 1008. The expedition in AD 1009 was against Nagarkot in the Kangra hills.
- Ghazni led 17 expeditions between AD 1001 and AD 1027. He plundered Thaneshwar, Mathura, Kannauj and Somnath. The temple of Somnath dedicated to Shiva was plundered in 1025 situated on the sea coast of Kathiawar (Gujarat).
- Utbi regarded as a great literary figure at that time, he was Mahmud's court historian. His *Kitab-ul-Yamini* or *Tarikh-I-Yamini* is a book on Mahmud's life and times.
- Firdausi (Persian poet) known as the immortal Homer of the East wrote the *Shahanama*, Al Beruni a brilliant scholar from Central Asia wrote *Tahqiq-i-hind*. Farukhi was also court poet of Ghazni.

Mohammed Ghori

- Muizzuddin Mohammed-bin-Sam (known as Mohammed Ghori), the last Turkish conqueror of North India, had no son.
- The King of Delhi Prithviraj Chauhan completely routed the Ghori's forces in AD 1191 at Tarain (First Battle of Tarain). But Prithviraj was defeated in the Second Battle of Tarain (AD 1192), Delhi and Ajmer were captured by Mohammed Ghori.

- Fall of Delhi and Ajmer laid the foundation of Muslim Rule in India. Ghori also defeated Jaichand (Ruler of Kannauj) at Battle of Chandawar in 1194. Bakhtiyar Khilji, his general, annexed East India and destroyed Nalanda and Vikramshila University. Ghori died in 1206, leaving Qutub-ud-din Aibak as incharge.
- Sufi Saint Khawaja Moin-ud-din Chisti came with him from Afghanistan. Tomb of Moin-ud-din Chisti is in Ajmer also known as Ajmer Sharif. He founded Chisti Silsilah.

THE DELHI SULTANATE

- Qutub-ud-din Aibak was Turkish slave by origin. He was purchased by Mohammad Ghori who later made him his Governor. After the death of Ghori, Aibak became the master of Hindustan and founded the slave dynasty in 1206. *The Delhi Sultanate (AD 1206-1526) had five ruling dynasties*
 - i. The Ilbari (Slave)
 - ii. The Khilji
 - iii. The Tughlaq
 - iv. The Sayyid
 - v. Lodhis
- Of these five dynasties the first three were of Turkish origin and the Lodhis were Afghans.

The Slave or Ilbari Dynasty

The first dynasty of the Sultanate has been designated by various scholars as the Slave dynasty or the Mamluq dynasty or the Ilbari dynasty.

Qutub-ud-din Aibak

- He was the founder of the Sultanate of Delhi. Qutub-ud-din Aibak was the first Muslim King of India. He began his reign with the modest title *Malik* and *Sipahsalar*, which had been conferred upon him by Mohammed Ghori. Lahore and later Delhi were his capitals.
- He was famous for his generosity and earned the sobriquet of *lakh-baksh* (giver of lakhs).
- He laid the foundation of Qutub Minar in Delhi after the name of the famous Sufi Saint Khwaja Qutub-ud-din Bakhtiyar Khilji. Aibak constructed the first mosque in India Quwat-ul-Islam (Delhi) and Adhai Din Ka Jhopara (At Ajmer).
- Hasan Nizami and Fakhr-ud-din (whom Aibak patronised) were all praised for the qualities of head and heart of Aibak and sense of justice in their works *Taj-ul Massir* and *Tarikh-i Mubarik Shahi* respectively.
- His task was only half done, when he died of a sudden fall from a horse at Lahore in 1210 while playing Chaugan (Polo).